penalties, and exemptions. Transferring it to another retirement account (e.g. a 401(k) to an IRA, or a Roth 401(k) to a Roth IRA) is your best bet for a simple rollover.

TIPS TO MAXIMIZE YOUR RETIREMENT INVESTMENTS

As you invest for retirement, here are some key steps you should consider taking to ensure you have the nest egg of your dreams:

> **Take full advantage of your employer's match if they offer one.** If your employer offers a match, take full advantage of it by contributing enough to get the full match. Otherwise you'll be leaving free money on the table, and nothing beats free money.
>
> **Start contributing toward your retirement savings as soon as you can.** Time is your best friend when it comes to building long-term wealth, especially for retirement. Thanks to the power of compounding, the sooner you start, the more money you'll have come retirement. Starting later? You'll need to be willing to play some catchup and make the extra effort by saving and investing more. This might mean stepping outside of your comfort zone by getting a better-paying job, adding a part-time job, or starting a side hustle to increase your income.
>
> **Max out your contributions if possible.** Not only will maxing out your annual contributions give you an annual tax break (since contributions to traditional plans are pre-tax, i.e. 401(k), 403(b), 457(b), traditional IRA), it will also get you closer to your retirement savings goals. If you are unable to max out your contributions right away, that's okay. Start with small increments of a percentage or two every quarter or every six months.
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> **Diversify your retirement investments.** It's all about choosing a mix of investments that can help you maximize your returns while still mitigating risk. Don't put all your money into one stock (including your company stock!), since doing this greatly amplifies your risk.